

100 Days of Linux - Day 021

Title: Finding Files and Directories with find

Today's Goal

Learn how to locate files and directories anywhere in the Linux filesystem using the **find** command.

Why This Matters

Developers and data engineers often need to locate configuration files, Python scripts, SQL files, logs, and datasets quickly.

Command of the Day: find

Syntax: `find path options`

Common Examples:

`find . -name "notes.txt"`

`find . -type d`

`find . -name "*.txt"`

Explanation: Searches for files and directories that match specific conditions.

Beginner Lesson

The dot (.) means the current directory. The **-name** option searches by name, and **-type d** searches only for directories. The **find** command is one of the most important Linux tools.

Practice Questions

1. Create three files named `app.py`, `notes.txt`, and `employees.csv`. Use `find` to locate `notes.txt` from the current directory.
2. Create two directories named `data` and `backup`. Use `find` to list only directories.
3. Use `find` to locate every `.txt` file in the current directory and its subdirectories.
4. Create a file named `report.txt` inside the `backup` directory. Use `find` to locate `report.txt`.
5. Display your current working directory after completing today's tasks.

Hints

Start searching from the current directory using a dot (.). Use quotes around patterns like `"*.txt"`.

Mini Challenge

Create a project folder with subfolders `python`, `sql`, and `linux`. Place one `.txt` file in each folder, then use a single `find` command to locate all `.txt` files.

Common Mistakes

Searching from the wrong directory. Run `pwd` first if you're unsure where you are.

Did You Know?

The `find` command can search by name, type, size, permissions, modification time, and much more.

Pro Tip

Use `find . -name "*.py"` to quickly locate all Python files in a project.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `find . -name "notes.txt"`

Q2: `find . -type d`

Q3: `find . -name "*.txt"`

Q4: `find . -name "report.txt"`

Q5: `pwd`

Homework

Create five files with different extensions and practice finding them by exact name and wildcard pattern.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn the `locate` command and compare it with `find`.